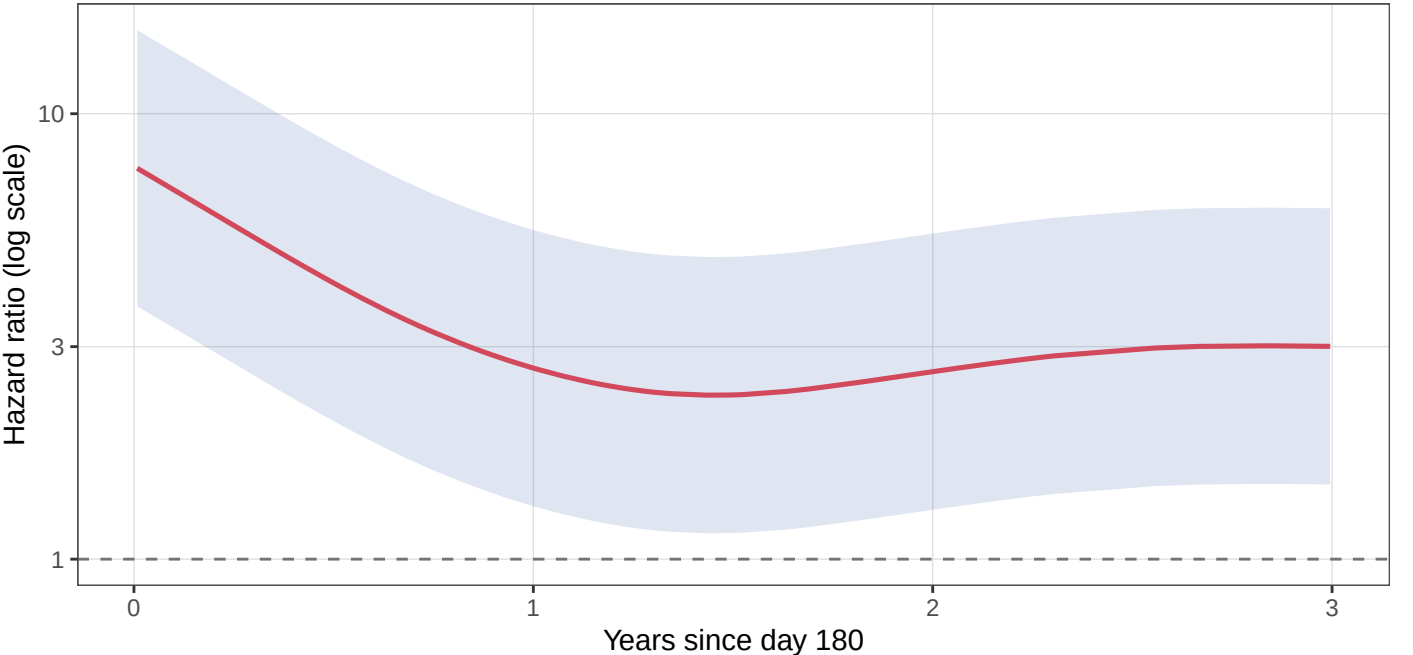


Excess risk is highest in the first year, then plateaus

Smoothed scaled Schoenfeld residuals from the primary model



The curve falls from roughly 7.5 to about 3 over the first year and then flattens; it does NOT decay toward the null, which is what a pure diagnostic work-up artefact would do. The plateau is the point, not flatness. The band is an approximate pointwise interval from the residual scatter, not a formal confidence band; the formal test is in F_S6.